At present, there are 24 SBCs. The name and the jurisdiction of all the 24 SBCs are mentioned in Table 69.1.

2. Composition

Any State Bar Council consists of the elected members as well as the ex-officio members. This is explained below:

1. In the case of a SBC with an electorate of five thousand – 15 members; in the case of a SBC with an electorate of five to ten thousand – 20 members; and in the case of SBC with an electorate of more than ten thousand – 25 members. They are elected in accordance with the system of proportional representation by means of the single transferable vote from amongst advocates on the electoral roll of the SBC. But, one-half of such elected members shall be persons who have for ten years been advocates on a state roll.

2. In case of any SBC, the Advocate-General of the state is the ex-officio member. Similarly, in case of a common SBC, the Advocate-General of each of the states is the ex-officio member. Further, in case of the SBC of Delhi, the Additional Solicitor-General of India is the ex-officio member.

Each SBC shall have a Chairman and a Vice-Chairman. They are elected by the Council amongst its members.

The term of office of an elected member of any SBC is five years. But, if any SBC fails to provide for the election of its members before the expiry of said term, then the BCI may extend the said term for a period of six months.

A State Bar Council consists of the following committees:

1. Disciplinary Committee (one or more)

2. Legal Aid Committee (one or more)

3. Executive Committee

4. Enrolment Committee

5. Other Committees (if necessary).

3. Functions

The functions of a State Bar Council are as follows:

1. To admit persons as advocates on its roll

2. To prepare and maintain such roll

3. To entertain and determine cases of misconduct against advocates on its roll

4. To safeguard the rights, privileges, and interests of advocates on its roll

5. To promote the growth of Bar Associations for the purposes of effective implementation of the welfare schemes for the indigent, disabled or other advocates